

talk about certain things, and certain things it's a little premature to talk about; but what I will say is that we are now going very strong in regional music. We have become No. 1 in Tamil music, we've made an entry into Telugu music, we've become No. 1 in Bhojpuri music. We are almost No. 1 in Gujarati music. In Hindi music, we have Sanjay Leela Bhansali now back with us, we have Karan Johar back with us. We have Akshay Kumar back with us; so we have some of the biggest names back with us and that's not because they like the look of my face or my people. It's because they're confident that Saregama can deliver the best result to them.

Q: You have created wealth with Saregama but your retail business Spencer's has not seen that kind of success. You did an interesting acquisition of Nature's Basket from Godrej but

if you look at the market value, Spencer's is still a fledgeling compared to the DMarts of the world and how fast they have grown in the last 10 years. What are your plans for this business?

A: Well, it is true that Spencer's has not grown at the pace others like DMart have grown, but we've taken a policy that we will not go for debt. Because we've not taken debt, we've remained small but we definitely want to grow now. Lots of initiatives are afoot at Spencer's. Out-of-store sales—call it digital, call it delivery, or call it on phone—that format is something we have been focussed on. Apparel, everyday wear, loungewear, relaxed wear—that is another area of focus as it is high margin. Nature's Basket was also in keeping with our philosophy of value-added retail. We don't want to be in the "*Sab se sasta* [cheaper than the rest]" game because there's no end to that. There's no end to discounting. Nature's Basket was a differentiated retailer aimed at the higher end of the market so that fitted in with our philosophy. And quite honestly, without meaning to sound condescending, we didn't want to become another Future Group.

So, yes you can say we have been too cautious and in hindsight, we could have been more aggressive but that's something we need to address now and we will do that.

Q: It's interesting you say this Sanjiv because you're getting into another pond which requires deep pockets, where you are up against some of the biggest players in the country—the FMCG business, whether it is foods with Too Yumm! or your hair care and skincare products. ITC has been trying to create this FMCG enterprise, with varying degrees of success, for a few years now and you know it requires a lot of financial muscle and staying power. Given the philosophy of not extending yourself on the balance sheet front, are you sure you're up for this game?

A: If I wasn't confident, I wouldn't have entered it and at the end of the day it's only time that's going to prove whether I'm right or not. Whatever I may say may sound not so convincing but if I have put my bets on this, I've done it with a conviction that we will succeed. Too Yumm! in a very short period has created a market for healthy western snacks. It's a market which did not exist in India. It's become the preferred brand for healthy snacking now. 'Naturally'—which is our brand for personal care—has just been launched in two cities so far, Bengaluru and NCR. No advertising, but [it has seen] an incredible amount of repeat business already. It's overwhelming. [It's] early days yet and [we have] a long way to go but the beginnings are very good. Yes, we know we are going to lose money. When you look at a power plant, you look at ₹5,000-10,000 crore of

